Updated Apr 2026

Alex Mendelson

Ecologist, Field Biologist, Science Communicator

Cell: (562) 225-9783
alexofecology@gmail.com

Education

MS Biology | California State University, Northridge — Expected May 2026

BS Biology (Zoology, Botany, and Ecology) | California State University, Long Beach — 2022

Field Experience

Restoration Intern | Tidal Influence, LLC, Long Beach, CA — 2023

- Conducted vegetation and avian surveys using line transects and quadrats in coastal restoration sites
- Supported environmental compliance monitoring during construction activities
- Assisted in native plant propagation and greenhouse management for restoration projects
- Monitored restoration site water quality
- Maintained and supported trail infrastructure and site access

Restoration Intern | Bolsa Chica Conservancy, Huntington Beach, CA — 2021–2023

- Performed long-term vegetation monitoring and habitat assessments in sensitive coastal wetlands
- Conducted vegetation mapping and patch analysis to support restoration and mitigation planning
- Assisted in endangered plant mitigation efforts, including monitoring and documentation
- Collected field data under variable environmental conditions and maintained accurate field records

Technical Skills

Field & Survey

- Vegetation monitoring (line/area transects, mapping)
- California native plant ID
- Avian surveys (visual & auditory ID)
- Water quality assessment (pH, salinity, DO_2, turbidity)

Compliance Support

- Field data collection and documentation
- Construction-adjacent monitoring
- Habitat assessment and restoration support

Data & Software

- R (statistical analysis)
- Python (automation, data processing)
- ImageJ, Fiji, Ilastik, OpenCV (image analysis)
- Adobe Creative Suite
- MS Excel and Word
- Google Sheets

Professional Service

Tree Canopy Assessment Research Project | US Forest Service, CSUN Urban Forestry — 2026
Fire-affected neighborhoods of Altadena, CA

President | Behavior, Ecology, and Evolution Research Club — 2024–2025
California State University, Northridge

Research Experience

Graduate Research 2023–present
terHorst Evolutionary Ecology Lab, California State University, Northridge

- Designed and conducted ecological experiments on temperature effects in aquatic microfauna
- Managed large datasets and automated analysis workflows
- Advanced image analysis for biological measurements
- Produced and presented results at regional and national conferences

Research Assistant 2021–2023
Pernet Larval Biology Lab, California State University, Long Beach

- Established the settlement strategy of an economically important marine fouling species
- Developed novel larval rearing and feeding systems
- Field collections of various marine invertebrates

Presentations

** denotes presenter*

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst, 2026. Adaptation to climate change and its indirect effects on rotifer ecology. Southern California Academy of Sciences, Anaheim, CA [**talk**]; CSUNposium, Northridge, CA [**talk**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. 2025. The search for indirect ecological effect of evolution in pitcher plant rotifers. Western Society of Naturalists, San Diego, CA [**talk**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. 2025. Does response to increased temperature differ among clones of pitcher plant rotifers? Evolution, Athens, GA [**poster**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. P. 2024. Different effects of temperature on pitcher plant rotifer clones. Ecological Society of America, Long Beach, CA [**poster**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. 2024. Ecological effect of evolution in pitcher plant rotifers as a response to temperature stress. CSUNposium, Northridge, CA [**poster**]

Mendelson, A. A*., K. Nuon, B. Pernet. 2022, 2023. It's all a big mistake: larval errors and the formation of new aggregations of the serpulid annelid *Ficopomatus enigmaticus*. Western Society of Naturalists, Monterey, CA [**talk**]; Southern California Academy of Sciences, Santa Barbara, CA [**talk**]; California Estuarine Research Society, Costa Mesa, CA [**poster**]; Western Society of Naturalists, Oxnard, CA [**poster**]

Publications

Mendelson, A. A., K. Nuon, B. Pernet. (2025). Gregarious and non-gregarious larval settlement in the aggregation-forming annelid *Ficopomatus enigmaticus*. *Biol. Bull.* Online ahead of print.